

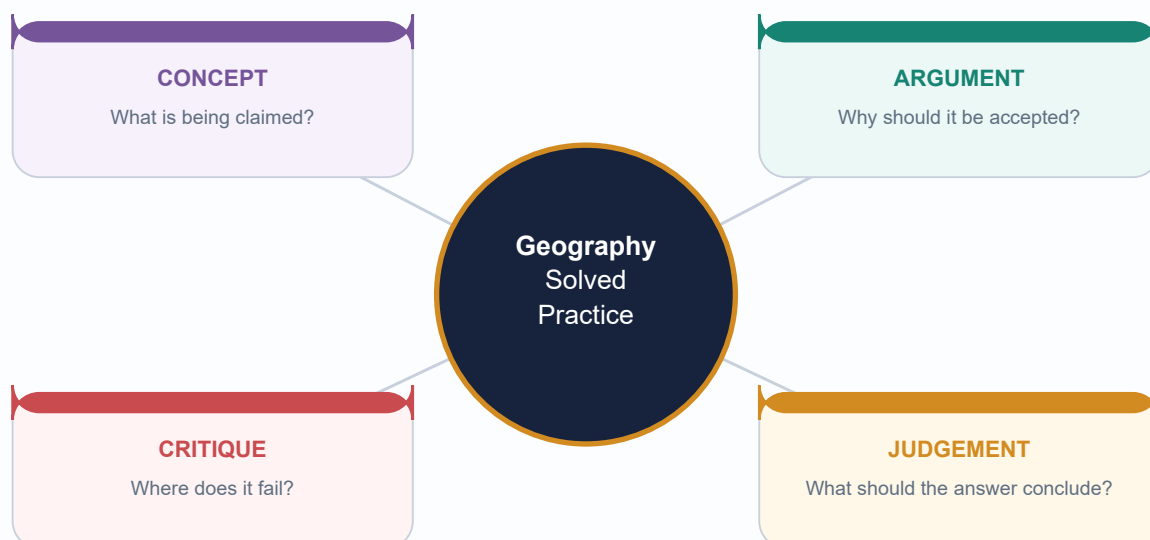
PREMIUM SOLVED WORKBOOK

Geography 29 - Solved Practice Workbook

Regional Development and Five Year Plans

Strict original-MCQ key rotation: A -> B -> C -> D

Export and evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026 | NOT APPROVED



Facts from official sources | Inferences clearly marked | No fabricated data

HIGH UPSC RELEVANCE

HIGH

1. Workbook protocol and PYQ provenance

GS-I / GS-II /
GS-III
Geography

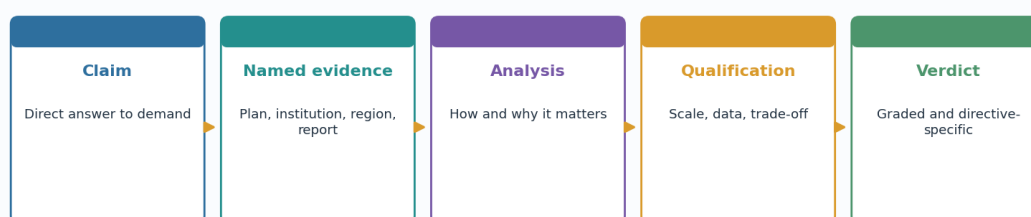
INTRO & ORIGIN

This solved workbook includes all directly relevant locally verified GS PYQs found in the repository routing and official scans, plus original hard and remedial practice.

WORKBOOK ANSWER PROTOCOL

UPSC answer spine

Every paragraph should move from proposition to proof, mechanism, limitation and judgement.



Workbook answer protocol

Original deterministic study visual generated for this package; schematic, not a data source.

STATIC THEORY

- Locally verified Mains set: 2018 Aspirational Districts, 2018 NITI versus Planning Commission, 2018 industrial corridors, 2022 Gati-Shakti and 2024 regional disparity.
- Locally verified objective wording: 2019 Five Year Plans. Official key unavailable in the local key set; answer retained as INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED with confidence and elimination logic.
- Hard MCQs span region types, regionalisation, measurement, theory, Indian pattern, Plan chronology, institutions and programmes.
- Correct keys rotate strictly A -> B -> C -> D through all 40 original MCQs.
- Every Mains solution uses claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification -> verdict and ends with Why this earns marks.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Retrieval and export date: 19 August 2026.
2. No coaching-site claim is treated as verified current fact.
3. Questions are solved, not merely routed.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: A routed PYQ can be copied without a full answer.

CORRECT: Premium workbook requires examiner-grade solution and evidence.

WRONG: An inferred key can be silently normalised.

CORRECT: Its status must remain prominent.

MAINS ANGLE

Use the workbook after revising the main learning session.

STUDY LINK

PYQ -> MCQ -> remedial -> Mains practice

HIGH

2. Workbook solved Prelims PYQ - 2019 Five Year Plans

GS-I / GS-II /
GS-III
Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exact question wording is recovered from the local official 2019 paper scan. The corresponding official key is not present in the local answer-key set.

PLAN-STRATEGY DISTINCTIONS FOR THE 2019 PYQ

Plan-strategy matrix

A Plan document states strategy and target; it does not prove achievement.

Agrarian foundation

First and Third emphasised agriculture, irrigation and the conditions of self-reliance.

Industrial deepening

Second established heavy-industry and capital-goods priority; later plans modernised it.

Poverty and employment

Fifth onward made distributive aims increasingly explicit.

Human development

Eighth and later plans elevated capabilities and social-sector outcomes.

Inclusion

Ninth to Eleventh sharpened equity and inclusive-growth language.

Sustainability

Twelfth integrated faster, inclusive and sustainable growth.

Plan-strategy distinctions for the 2019 PYQ

Original deterministic study visual generated for this package; schematic, not a data source.

STATIC THEORY

- **Question:** With reference to India's Five-Year Plans, which of the following statements is/are correct?

- **1.** From the Second Five-Year Plan, there was a determined thrust towards substitution of basic and capital good industries.

- **2.** The Fourth Five-Year Plan adopted the objective of correcting the earlier trend of increased concentration of wealth and economic power.

- **3.** In the Fifth Five-Year Plan, for the first time, the financial sector was included as an integral part of the Plan.

- **Options:** (A) 1 and 2 only; (B) 2 only; (C) 3 only; (D) 1, 2 and 3.

- **INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED (High confidence): A.** Statement 1 reflects the Second Plan's heavy/basic and capital-goods thrust. Statement 2 is consistent with the Fourth Plan's distributive objective. Statement 3 is incorrect; the Fifth Plan is not the first integration of the financial sector, and systemic financial-sector reform belongs to the post-1991/Eighth Plan phase.

- **Elimination logic:** rejecting statement 3 removes C and D; accepting the documented Second- and Fourth-Plan thrusts selects A.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. PYQ year: 2019.

2. Question wording locally verified.

3. Key status is explicitly inferred, not represented as official.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: A high-confidence inference may be called official.

CORRECT: Key provenance must remain explicit.

WRONG: Statement 3 can be accepted because banking existed.

CORRECT: The stem asks whether the financial sector was first included as an integral Plan component, a different claim.

MAINS ANGLE

Verify each statement independently and preserve the key-status label.

STUDY LINK

Prelims planning chronology

HIGH**3. Workbook solved Mains PYQ - 2024 regional disparity**

GS-I / GS-II /
GS-III
Geography

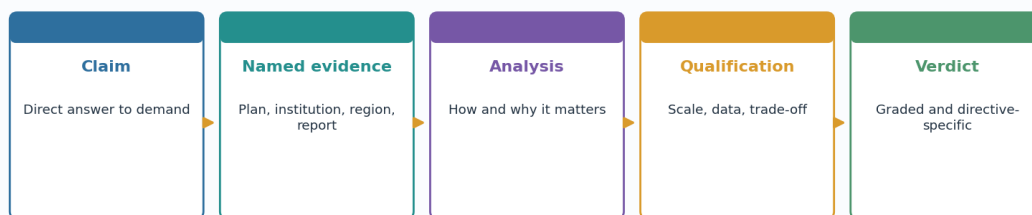
INTRO & ORIGIN

Solved UPSC Mains PYQ. The model answer follows claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification -> verdict.

CLAIM-EVIDENCE-ANALYSIS-QUALIFICATION-VERDICT ANSWER SPINE

UPSC answer spine

Every paragraph should move from proposition to proof, mechanism, limitation and judgement.



Claim-evidence-analysis-qualification-verdict answer spine

Original deterministic study visual generated for this package; schematic, not a data source.

STATIC THEORY

- **Question (15 marks):** What is regional disparity? How does it differ from diversity? How Serious is the issue of regional disparity in India? (Answer in 250 words)
- **Directive and thesis:** Define disparity as ranked inequality in comparable development outcomes, distinguish it from unranked diversity, and judge seriousness as high but multidimensional and nested rather than uniform.
- **Claim 1:** Disparity and diversity are analytically different. **Named evidence/example:** The formal distinction in this package: culture/ecology can differ without a welfare ranking, while per-capita income, service access and human development can be ranked. **Analysis:** This prevents policy from treating identity as a deficit and focuses redistribution on disadvantage.
- **Claim 2:** The issue is serious across multiple scales. **Named evidence/example:** Named Indian contrasts include Mumbai-Pune versus Vidarbha/Marathwada, coastal versus interior Odisha, metropolitan cores versus peri-urban belts, and hill/tribal/mineral districts. **Analysis:** These show interstate, intrastate and rural-urban mechanisms rather than one poor-state map.
- **Claim 3:** Cumulative causation can make gaps persistent. **Named evidence/example:** Myrdal's backwash through selective migration, capital and market concentration; Perroux/Boudeville growth-pole logic; Friedmann core-periphery. **Analysis:** Initial advantages become self-reinforcing unless spread linkages and public capabilities are built.
- **Claim 4:** Policy has moved to finer territorial targeting. **Named evidence/example:** Plan-era special-area programmes, Finance Commission transfers, ADP since 2018 and ABP since 2023. **Analysis:** The shift recognises that state averages conceal district and block deprivation.
- **Qualification:** State composites and named examples cannot substitute for current, comparable sub-state data; some social indicators may converge even while productivity and ecological gaps persist.
- **Verdict:** Regional disparity is a first-order development and federal challenge, but the remedy is not uniformity: universal capabilities, place-specific public goods, functional-region coordination and accountable fiscal support should make spread exceed backwash.
- **Why this earns marks:** It answers every part of the directive, uses named evidence to prove each claim, explains the spatial mechanism, states a limitation and ends with a graded verdict.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Marks: 15.
2. Exact wording verified from a local official paper scan.
3. Every evidence unit is analytical, not decorative.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: A scheme list is an answer.

CORRECT: The answer must explain mechanism, evidence and limitation.

WRONG: A generic conclusion is enough.

CORRECT: The verdict must resolve the directive and scale.

MAINS ANGLE

Reproduce the structure under timed conditions and add a compact schematic.

STUDY LINK

Solved PYQ -> examiner-grade model -> revision

HIGH

4. Workbook solved Mains PYQ - 2018 Aspirational Districts

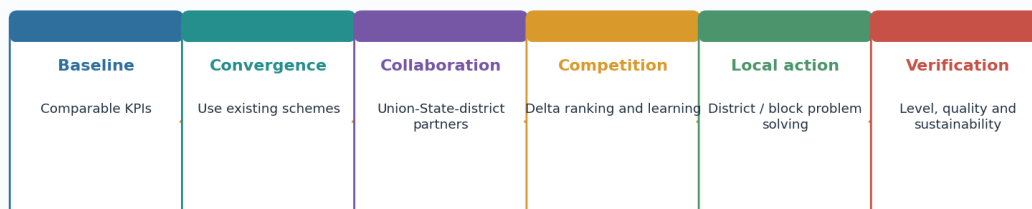
GS-I / GS-II /
GS-III
Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Solved UPSC Mains PYQ. The model answer follows claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification -> verdict.

CLAIM-EVIDENCE-ANALYSIS-QUALIFICATION-VERDICT ANSWER SPINE**ADP and ABP operating logic**

Delta improvement is a management signal, not proof of absolute development or causal impact.

*Claim-evidence-analysis-qualification-verdict answer spine*

Original deterministic study visual generated for this package; schematic, not a data source.

STATIC THEORY

- **Question (15 marks):** Mention core strategies for the transformation of aspirational districts in India and explain the nature of convergence, collaboration and competition for its success. (Answer in 250 words)
- **Directive and thesis:** The Aspirational model is a territorial governance method: use existing schemes coherently, align institutions and motivate improvement through transparent comparison.
- **Claim 1:** Convergence reduces programme fragmentation. **Named evidence/example:** ADP's five focus areas and KPI framework align Union and state schemes at district level. **Analysis:** It converts separate departmental inputs into a district outcome strategy rather than creating one new universal scheme.
- **Claim 2:** Collaboration turns data into local problem solving. **Named evidence/example:** District administration, state, NITI, Union ministries and development partners work through field-level reviews and knowledge exchange. **Analysis:** Cross-level coordination can resolve clearance points and adapt interventions to local constraints.
- **Claim 3:** Competition focuses attention on incremental change. **Named evidence/example:** Monthly delta-ranking logic compares improvement rather than only static level. **Analysis:** It can motivate lagging districts and spread replicable practices.
- **Claim 4:** Capacity and data quality determine durability. **Named evidence/example:** District staffing, denominator integrity, verification and O&M are the practical conditions behind dashboard movement. **Analysis:** Without them, competition can reward reporting rather than transformation.
- **Qualification:** Delta rank is not absolute development level or causal impact; hard-to-move structural indicators and within-district inequality can remain hidden.
- **Verdict:** ADP succeeds when convergence supplies resources, collaboration supplies implementation capacity and competition supplies focus, while independent verification and local accountability convert dashboard gains into durable capabilities.
- **Why this earns marks:** It answers every part of the directive, uses named evidence to prove each claim, explains the spatial mechanism, states a limitation and ends with a graded verdict.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Marks: 15.
2. Exact wording verified from a local official paper scan.
3. Every evidence unit is analytical, not decorative.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: A scheme list is an answer.

CORRECT: The answer must explain mechanism, evidence and limitation.

WRONG: A generic conclusion is enough.

CORRECT: The verdict must resolve the directive and scale.

MAINS ANGLE

Reproduce the structure under timed conditions and add a compact schematic.

STUDY LINK

Solved PYQ -> examiner-grade model -> revision

HIGH

5. Workbook solved Mains PYQ - 2018 NITI versus Planning Commission

GS-I / GS-II /
GS-III
Geography

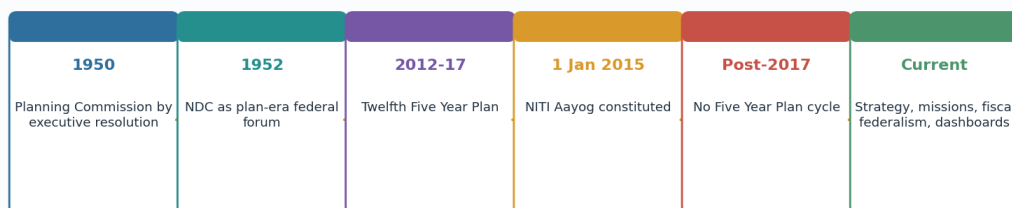
INTRO & ORIGIN

Solved UPSC Mains PYQ. The model answer follows claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification -> verdict.

CLAIM-EVIDENCE-ANALYSIS-QUALIFICATION-VERDICT ANSWER SPINE

Institutional transition: do not convert NITI into a Thirteenth Plan

The Planning Commission was replaced in 2015, but the Twelfth Plan ran to 2017. No new Five Year Plan followed.

*Claim-evidence-analysis-qualification-verdict answer spine*

Original deterministic study visual generated for this package; schematic, not a data source.

STATIC THEORY

- **Question (15 marks):** How are the principles followed by the NITI Aayog different from those followed by the erstwhile Planning Commission in India? (Answer in 250 words)
- **Directive and thesis:** The change is from central plan formulation and plan-assistance bargaining to advisory strategy, cooperative-federal platforms and monitoring; it is neither total discontinuity of planning nor continuation of Five Year Plans.
- **Claim 1:** Mandate and output differ. **Named evidence/example:** Planning Commission formulated Five Year Plans; NITI is an executive policy think tank issuing strategy, knowledge and monitoring outputs. **Analysis:** The Twelfth Plan was the last; NITI did not prepare a Thirteenth Plan.
- **Claim 2:** Fiscal authority differs. **Named evidence/example:** The Planning Commission historically influenced plan assistance; NITI does not allocate plan funds. **Analysis:** Current transfers operate through the Finance Commission, Union Budget and scheme architecture.
- **Claim 3:** Federal method differs. **Named evidence/example:** NITI Governing Council and regional mechanisms emphasise partnership with states. **Analysis:** This replaces much of the one-way plan negotiation with cooperative and competitive federalism, though bargaining remains elsewhere.
- **Claim 4:** Monitoring style differs. **Named evidence/example:** ADP/ABP, indices and dashboards compare states, districts and blocks. **Analysis:** Territorial granularity and continuous monitoring supplement periodic plan documents.
- **Qualification:** NITI's advisory character can encourage flexibility and learning but also limits enforcement and fiscal leverage; implementation remains dispersed across ministries and states.
- **Verdict:** NITI represents a change in institutional style and instruments, not the end of planning and not a renamed Planning Commission: its value depends on whether advice, federal coordination and evidence are translated into funded and accountable action.
- **Why this earns marks:** It answers every part of the directive, uses named evidence to prove each claim, explains the spatial mechanism, states a limitation and ends with a graded verdict.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Marks: 15.
2. Exact wording verified from a local official paper scan.
3. Every evidence unit is analytical, not decorative.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: A scheme list is an answer.

CORRECT: The answer must explain mechanism, evidence and limitation.

WRONG: A generic conclusion is enough.

CORRECT: The verdict must resolve the directive and scale.

MAINS ANGLE

Reproduce the structure under timed conditions and add a compact schematic.

STUDY LINK

Solved PYQ -> examiner-grade model -> revision

HIGH

6. Workbook solved Mains PYQ - 2018 industrial corridors

GS-I / GS-II /
GS-III
Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Solved UPSC Mains PYQ. The model answer follows claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification -> verdict.

CLAIM-EVIDENCE-ANALYSIS-QUALIFICATION-VERDICT ANSWER SPINE

Corridor and cluster development

Connectivity can create regional multipliers only when nodes, local firms, skills and ecological systems connect.

Anchor infrastructure

Freight, road, rail, port, power and digital backbones.

Industrial nodes

Serviced land, logistics and urban systems at selected locations.

Local linkages

MSME suppliers, farmers, workers, skills and innovation institutions.

Intermediate towns

Distribute services and prevent one-metro capture.

Risk firewall

Land conflict, displacement, water stress, debt and enclave formation.

Outcome test

Travel time, firm entry, jobs, wages, emissions and spatial distribution.

Claim-evidence-analysis-qualification-verdict answer spine

Original deterministic study visual generated for this package; schematic, not a data source.

STATIC THEORY

- **Question (15 marks):** What is the significance of Industrial Corridors in India? Identifying industrial corridors, explain their main characteristics. (Answer in 250 words)

- **Directive and thesis:** Industrial corridors are networked regional-development systems linking trunk infrastructure, industrial nodes, logistics and urban services; their significance lies in reducing coordination costs, not merely drawing a transport line.

- **Claim 1:** Corridors can deepen manufacturing and logistics. **Named evidence/example:** Delhi-Mumbai, Chennai-Bengaluru and other corridor programmes are organised around freight, roads, ports, power and industrial nodes. **Analysis:** Co-location and connectivity can reduce travel time, inventory and infrastructure uncertainty.

- **Claim 2:** They can restructure regional space. **Named evidence/example:** Dedicated nodes, secondary cities and supplier clusters can distribute investment beyond established metros. **Analysis:** This creates a potential growth-pole network rather than one primate core.

- **Claim 3:** Their main characteristics are multi-modal and node-based. **Named evidence/example:** Trunk corridors, industrial townships, logistics hubs, land systems and investment facilitation. **Analysis:** The corridor is an integrated planning region, not a single road or railway.

- **Claim 4:** Local linkages determine inclusive significance. **Named evidence/example:** MSME sourcing, skills, housing, transit and water planning around nodes. **Analysis:** Without these, a corridor becomes an enclave or speculative land strip.

- **Qualification:** Land acquisition, ecological pressure, inter-state coordination and unequal node selection can create backwash and bypassed hinterlands.

- **Verdict:** Industrial corridors are significant when they connect national logistics efficiency with local firm capability, intermediate towns and ecological safeguards; kilometres of infrastructure alone are an output, not regional transformation.

- **Why this earns marks:** It answers every part of the directive, uses named evidence to prove each claim, explains the spatial mechanism, states a limitation and ends with a graded verdict.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Marks: 15.
2. Exact wording verified from a local official paper scan.
3. Every evidence unit is analytical, not decorative.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: A scheme list is an answer.

CORRECT: The answer must explain mechanism, evidence and limitation.

WRONG: A generic conclusion is enough.

CORRECT: The verdict must resolve the directive and scale.

MAINS ANGLE

Reproduce the structure under timed conditions and add a compact schematic.

STUDY LINK

Solved PYQ -> examiner-grade model -> revision

HIGH

7. Workbook solved Mains PYQ - 2022 Gati-Shakti

GS-I / GS-II /
GS-III
Geography

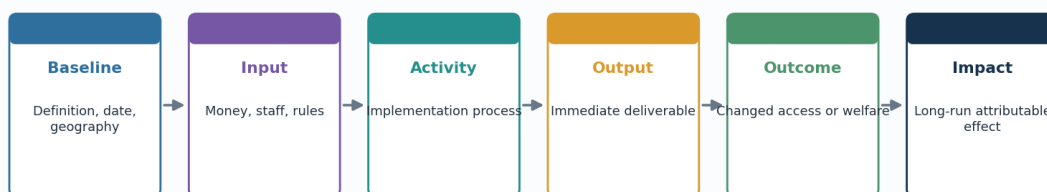
INTRO & ORIGIN

Solved UPSC Mains PYQ. The model answer follows claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification -> verdict.

CLAIM-EVIDENCE-ANALYSIS-QUALIFICATION-VERDICT ANSWER SPINE

Monitoring and evaluation chain

A dashboard is useful only when the indicator, data-generating process and response loop are credible.



Evaluation asks: compared with what counterfactual, for whom, at what cost, and with what spillovers?

Accountability loop: public data -> verification -> course correction -> legislative/local scrutiny

Claim-evidence-analysis-qualification-verdict answer spine

Original deterministic study visual generated for this package; schematic, not a data source.

STATIC THEORY

- **Question (10 marks):** The Gati-Shakti Yojana needs meticulous coordination between the government and the private sector to achieve the goal of connectivity. Discuss. (Answer in 150 words)
- **Directive and thesis:** PM Gati-Shakti addresses a systems-level coordination failure in multimodal infrastructure, but private participation must operate within public spatial, social and ecological accountability.
- **Claim 1:** Government coordination is required across networks and jurisdictions. **Named evidence/example:** The unified geospatial planning approach spans ministries, states and project agencies. **Analysis:** It can identify missing links, sequencing conflicts and duplicated works.
- **Claim 2:** Private capability can support finance, logistics, construction and operations. **Named evidence/example:** Industrial nodes, warehousing, ports and digital logistics depend on commercial users and operators. **Analysis:** Early coordination can align demand, standards and project timing.
- **Claim 3:** Regional outcomes need public safeguards. **Named evidence/example:** Land, resettlement, urban services, water and environmental clearances remain public responsibilities. **Analysis:** Connectivity that bypasses local economies may raise throughput without balanced development.
- **Qualification:** A platform improves information and sequencing but cannot by itself resolve weak contracts, local capacity, maintenance or distributional conflict.
- **Verdict:** Meticulous coordination should be judged by interoperable planning, transparent project pipelines, local linkage and outcome metrics such as reliability and travel-time reduction, not only asset completion.
- **Why this earns marks:** It answers every part of the directive, uses named evidence to prove each claim, explains the spatial mechanism, states a limitation and ends with a graded verdict.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Marks: 10.
2. Exact wording verified from a local official paper scan.
3. Every evidence unit is analytical, not decorative.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: A scheme list is an answer.

CORRECT: The answer must explain mechanism, evidence and limitation.

WRONG: A generic conclusion is enough.

CORRECT: The verdict must resolve the directive and scale.

MAINS ANGLE

Reproduce the structure under timed conditions and add a compact schematic.

STUDY LINK

Solved PYQ -> examiner-grade model -> revision

HIGH**8. Hard MCQs 1-8 - region, measurement and theory**

GS-I / GS-II /
GS-III
Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Solved practice. The correct-key sequence is mechanically fixed A -> B -> C -> D without consecutive repetition.

PRACTICE CONCEPT MAP**Regional concept taxonomy**

The same territory can be formal, functional, planning and administrative depending on the analytical purpose.

Formal / homogeneous

Internal similarity on one or more selected attributes: rainfall, crop, language or poverty.

Functional

Flows and interaction bind the area: commuting, trade, basin, service or supply chain.

Nodal

A functional region organised around a dominant centre and its hinterland.

Planning

A deliberately bounded territory for diagnosis, strategy and coordination.

Administrative

A legally or bureaucratically delimited unit through which authority and budgets operate.

Vernacular / perceptual

A lived or imagined region recognised by identity and common usage.

Practice concept map

Original deterministic study visual generated for this package; schematic, not a data source.

STATIC THEORY

- **Q1. Which definition best identifies a formal region?** A. An area homogeneous on a selected attribute | B. A commuting field around a city | C. A district created by statute | D. A corridor joining ports

- **Correct: A.** Formal regions are delimited by internal similarity; the other options are functional, administrative or network regions.

- **Q2. A metropolitan labour market extending across district borders is primarily a:** A. Formal region | B. Functional region | C. Special-category state | D. Plan holiday

- **Correct: B.** Interaction and commuting flows create functional unity.

- **Q3. Which method is most directly suited to grouping districts with similar multivariate development profiles?** A. Single contour overlay | B. Administrative notification | C. Cluster analysis after standardisation | D. A project sanction list
- **Correct: C.** Cluster methods group similar observations, but contiguity must still be tested.
- **Q4. Which statement shows correct denominator discipline?** A. Compare aggregate GSDP alone | B. Use any population year | C. Mix current and constant prices | D. Match numerator, population, year, boundary and price basis
- **Correct: D.** Comparability requires a common definition, geography and time basis.
- **Q5. Sigma convergence occurs when:** A. Dispersion across regional outcomes falls | B. All regions have identical sector structures | C. A leader grows faster | D. A dashboard rank changes
- **Correct: A.** Sigma convergence concerns falling dispersion.
- **Q6. Circular and cumulative causation is most associated with:** A. Perroux | B. Myrdal | C. Christaller | D. Rostow
- **Correct: B.** Myrdal explains self-reinforcing regional advantage and backwash.
- **Q7. A growth pole becomes a regional-development instrument only when:** A. It is located in a capital city | B. It receives a subsidy | C. Propulsive activity creates durable local linkages | D. It exports all output
- **Correct: C.** Linkage and multiplier effects distinguish a pole from a large enclave investment.
- **Q8. Which is the strongest criticism of unbalanced-growth strategy?** A. It never uses infrastructure | B. It excludes sequencing | C. It assumes no linkages | D. Initial concentration may persist and be politically captured
- **Correct: D.** Induced linkages may not materialise or may be blocked.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Questions covered: 1-8.
2. Four plausible options per question.
3. Every answer includes elimination-oriented explanation.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Option position may be guessed from wording.

CORRECT: All options are designed to be plausible; verify concept first.

WRONG: Rotation changes the factual answer.

CORRECT: Rotation is applied only after the correct proposition is fixed.

MAINS ANGLE

Attempt without viewing the answer line, then explain why each distractor fails.

STUDY LINK

MCQ loop -> remedial loop -> register notes

HIGH**9. Hard MCQs 9-16 - policy and early Plans**

GS-I / GS-II /
GS-III
Geography

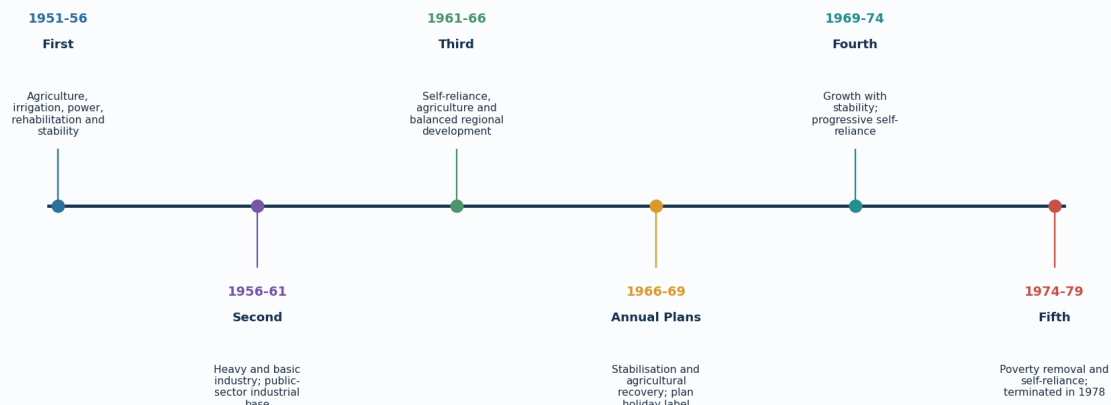
INTRO & ORIGIN

Solved practice. The correct-key sequence is mechanically fixed A -> B -> C -> D without consecutive repetition.

PRACTICE CONCEPT MAP

Five Year Plan chronology I: 1951-79

Dates, official thrusts and interruptions are kept distinct from later outcomes.



Practice concept map

Original deterministic study visual generated for this package; schematic, not a data source.

STATIC THEORY

- **Q9. Which is a place-based policy?** A. Restoring a drought-prone region's watershed and town network | B. Portable food entitlement for migrants | C. Universal vaccination | D. National scholarship portability

- **Correct: A.** The intervention targets a territorial opportunity structure.

- **Q10. Which is primarily people-based?** A. Industrial node infrastructure | B. Portable social protection and skills | C. River-basin authority | D. Freight terminal

- **Correct: B.** People-based policy expands capability independent of place.

- **Q11. For average state-income comparison, which is generally more appropriate than aggregate GSDP?** A. Gross capital formation | B. Fiscal deficit | C. Per-capita NSDP with metadata | D. Project outlay

- **Correct: C.** Per-capita NSDP provides an average-income indicator, subject to distribution and price caveats.

- **Q12. A district tops a monthly delta ranking. What follows?** A. It has the highest income | B. It has eliminated poverty | C. The programme caused all change | D. It improved fastest under the dashboard method, not necessarily to the highest level

- **Correct: D.** Delta ranking measures relative improvement, not absolute development or causality.

- **Q13. The First Five Year Plan primarily emphasised:** A. Agriculture, irrigation and power | B. Heavy capital goods alone | C. Financial deregulation | D. GST harmonisation

- **Correct: A.** The post-Partition context made agriculture, irrigation, rehabilitation and stability central.

- **Q14. The Mahalanobis heavy-industry strategy is linked to the:** A. First Plan | B. Second Plan | C. Fourth Plan | D. Eighth Plan

- **Correct: B.** The Second Plan prioritised heavy and basic industry.

- **Q15. Which Plan first made balanced regional development an explicit major planning concern in the standard chronology used here?** A. First | B. Second | C. Third | D. Fifth

- **Correct: C.** The Third Plan explicitly incorporated balanced regional development alongside agriculture and self-reliance.

- **Q16. Growth with stability and progressive achievement of self-reliance describes the:** A. Second Plan | B. Third Plan | C. Fifth Plan | D. Fourth Plan

- **Correct: D.** This is the Fourth Plan's dominant strategy wording.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Questions covered: 9-16.
2. Four plausible options per question.
3. Every answer includes elimination-oriented explanation.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Option position may be guessed from wording.

CORRECT: All options are designed to be plausible; verify concept first.

WRONG: Rotation changes the factual answer.

CORRECT: Rotation is applied only after the correct proposition is fixed.

MAINS ANGLE

Attempt without viewing the answer line, then explain why each distractor fails.

STUDY LINK

MCQ loop -> remedial loop -> register notes

HIGH

10. Hard MCQs 17-24 - later Plans and transition

GS-I / GS-II /
GS-III
Geography

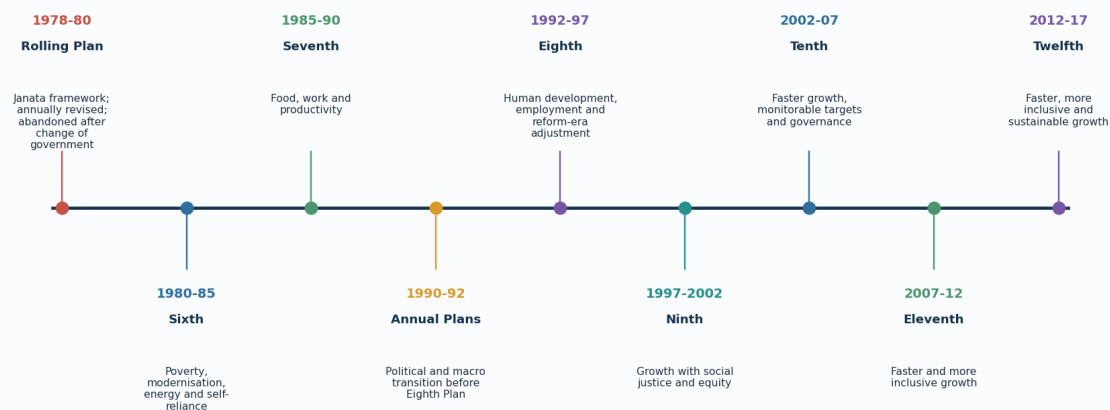
INTRO & ORIGIN

Solved practice. The correct-key sequence is mechanically fixed A -> B -> C -> D without consecutive repetition.

PRACTICE CONCEPT MAP

Five Year Plan chronology II: 1978-2017

The Rolling Plan and 1990-92 Annual Plans are separate interruptions; the Twelfth was the last Five Year Plan.



Practice concept map

Original deterministic study visual generated for this package; schematic, not a data source.

STATIC THEORY

- **Q17. Removal of poverty and self-reliance are associated with the:** A. Fifth Plan | B. Fourth Plan | C. Sixth Plan | D. Ninth Plan

- **Correct: A.** The Fifth Plan carried these central objectives and was terminated early in 1978.

- **Q18. The operative Rolling Plan interlude occurred during:** A. 1966-69 | B. 1978-80 | C. 1990-92 | D. 2012-17

- **Correct: B.** The Janata Rolling Plan was abandoned after the 1980 political change.
- **Q19. Food, work and productivity is the classic formulation of the:** A. Sixth Plan | B. Eighth Plan | C. Seventh Plan | D. Tenth Plan
- **Correct: C.** The Seventh Plan emphasised food, work and productivity.
- **Q20. The Eighth Plan began in 1992 mainly because:** A. The Fifth Plan was extended | B. The Finance Commission delayed it | C. The NDC was abolished | D. Annual Plans covered 1990-92 amid political and macro transition
- **Correct: D.** Two Annual Plans preceded the Eighth Plan.
- **Q21. Growth with social justice and equity best identifies the:** A. Ninth Plan | B. Tenth Plan | C. Eleventh Plan | D. Twelfth Plan
- **Correct: A.** The Ninth Plan used this distributive emphasis.
- **Q22. Faster and More Inclusive Growth is the title associated with the:** A. Tenth Plan | B. Eleventh Plan | C. Twelfth Plan | D. Rolling Plan
- **Correct: B.** The Eleventh Plan used this formulation.
- **Q23. Faster, More Inclusive and Sustainable Growth is the:** A. Ninth Plan | B. Tenth Plan | C. Twelfth Plan | D. Post-2017 Action Agenda
- **Correct: C.** It is the Twelfth Plan title.
- **Q24. Which statement about post-2017 India is correct?** A. The Thirteenth Plan is operative | B. NITI allocates plan funds | C. The Plan Holiday resumed | D. No new Five Year Plan followed; planning uses other instruments
- **Correct: D.** Planning persists without a Five Year Plan cycle.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Questions covered: 17-24.
2. Four plausible options per question.
3. Every answer includes elimination-oriented explanation.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Option position may be guessed from wording.

CORRECT: All options are designed to be plausible; verify concept first.

WRONG: Rotation changes the factual answer.

CORRECT: Rotation is applied only after the correct proposition is fixed.

MAINS ANGLE

Attempt without viewing the answer line, then explain why each distractor fails.

STUDY LINK

MCQ loop -> remedial loop -> register notes

HIGH**11. Hard MCQs 25-32 - institutions and programmes**

GS-I / GS-II /
GS-III
Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Solved practice. The correct-key sequence is mechanically fixed A -> B -> C -> D without consecutive repetition.

PRACTICE CONCEPT MAP

Federal institutions: distinct mandates

Coordination, fiscal transfer, taxation and planning must not be collapsed into one institution.

*Practice concept map*

Original deterministic study visual generated for this package; schematic, not a data source.

STATIC THEORY

- **Q25. Which institution historically formulated Five Year Plans?** A. Planning Commission | B. Finance Commission | C. GST Council | D. Inter-State Council
- **Correct: A.** The Planning Commission was the plan-formulation institution.
- **Q26. Which constitutional body recommends tax devolution between Union and States?** A. NITI Aayog | B. Finance Commission | C. National Development Council | D. Zonal Council
- **Correct: B.** Article 280 establishes the Finance Commission.
- **Q27. Which body consolidates Panchayat and municipal plans at district level?** A. GST Council | B. NITI Governing Council | C. District Planning Committee | D. North Eastern Council
- **Correct: C.** Article 243ZD provides for the DPC.
- **Q28. Article 279A relates to the:** A. Finance Commission | B. Inter-State Council | C. Metropolitan Planning Committee | D. GST Council
- **Correct: D.** Article 279A establishes the GST Council.
- **Q29. The Gadgil formula was primarily connected with:** A. Plan-era Normal Central Assistance to State Plans | B. Current GST compensation | C. Private corridor finance | D. DMF contribution
- **Correct: A.** It belonged to the plan-assistance architecture.
- **Q30. The Tribal Sub-Plan is best understood as:** A. A single road scheme | B. A cross-sector resource strategy originating in the Fifth Plan | C. A Finance Commission tax formula | D. A metropolitan institution
- **Correct: B.** TSP/DAPST is a budgeting and planning strategy, not one scheme.
- **Q31. The Command Area Development Programme evolved into:** A. BADP | B. BRGF | C. Command Area Development and Water Management | D. ADP
- **Correct: C.** CADWM is the later programme lineage.

- **Q32. District Mineral Foundations derive their statutory basis from:** A. Article 280 | B. The NEC Act | C. The Finance Act | D. MMDR Act section 9B

- **Correct: D.** The 2015 amendment inserted DMF provisions in section 9B.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Questions covered: 25-32.
2. Four plausible options per question.
3. Every answer includes elimination-oriented explanation.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Option position may be guessed from wording.

CORRECT: All options are designed to be plausible; verify concept first.

WRONG: Rotation changes the factual answer.

CORRECT: Rotation is applied only after the correct proposition is fixed.

MAINS ANGLE

Attempt without viewing the answer line, then explain why each distractor fails.

STUDY LINK

MCQ loop -> remedial loop -> register notes

HIGH

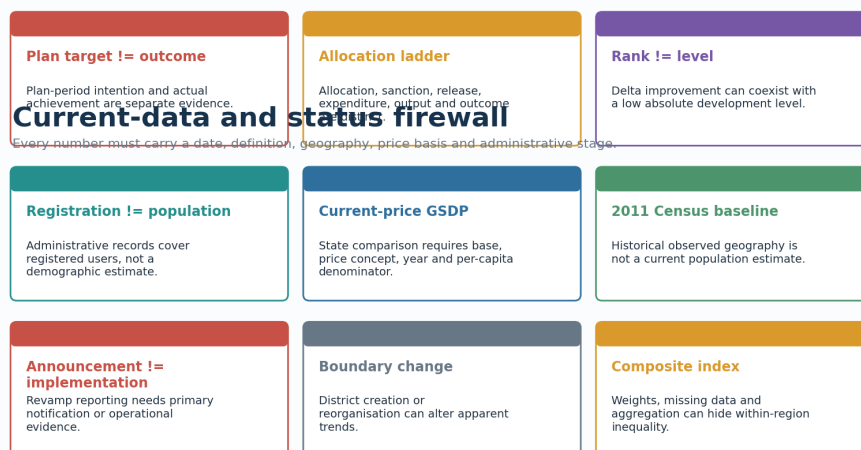
12. Remedial MCQs 33-40 - common errors

GS-I / GS-II /
GS-III
Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Solved practice. The correct-key sequence is mechanically fixed A -> B -> C -> D without consecutive repetition.

PRACTICE CONCEPT MAP



Practice concept map

Original deterministic study visual generated for this package; schematic, not a data source.

STATIC THEORY

- **Q33. A district boundary is most accurately classified as:** A. Administrative, though it may be used as a planning region | B. Necessarily functional | C. Necessarily homogeneous | D. A growth pole

- **Correct: A.** Administrative and analytical classifications must be separated.

- **Q34. A high delta rank but low absolute level means:** A. The data are impossible | B. Improvement and level are different measures | C. The district is fully developed | D. The denominator is irrelevant
- **Correct: B.** The dashboard can show rapid change from a low base.
- **Q35. A Plan target should be treated as:** A. A current outcome | B. A constitutional obligation | C. An officially stated intention requiring separate achievement evidence | D. A population estimate
- **Correct: C.** Targets and outcomes are distinct.
- **Q36. Which sequence correctly orders financial-administrative stages?** A. Outcome -> allocation -> sanction | B. Expenditure -> sanction -> release | C. Release -> allocation -> output | D. Allocation -> sanction -> release -> expenditure -> output -> outcome
- **Correct: D.** The ladder prevents budget and impact conflation.
- **Q37. The best test of corridor-led regional development is:** A. Local linkages, job quality, travel time and ecological distribution | B. Length alone | C. Announcement date | D. Number of logos
- **Correct: A.** Outcome and distribution metrics are required.
- **Q38. Special-category state status should not be confused with:** A. A plan-era administrative classification | B. Constitutional special provisions or any ad hoc special package | C. Historical central assistance | D. Regional cost disability
- **Correct: B.** The legal and fiscal bases differ.
- **Q39. Census 2011 district population can safely be used as:** A. A 2026 current estimate | B. A dashboard outcome | C. A dated observed baseline with boundary caveats | D. A project sanction
- **Correct: C.** It is historical observed evidence, not current population geography.
- **Q40. How should a media report about an ADP revamp be used?** A. As an implemented programme | B. As a notified guideline | C. As a current allocation | D. As unconfirmed discovery until primary official implementation evidence appears
- **Correct: D.** Announcement/revamp reporting is not official implementation.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Questions covered: 33-40.
2. Four plausible options per question.
3. Every answer includes elimination-oriented explanation.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Option position may be guessed from wording.

CORRECT: All options are designed to be plausible; verify concept first.

WRONG: Rotation changes the factual answer.

CORRECT: Rotation is applied only after the correct proposition is fixed.

MAINS ANGLE

Attempt without viewing the answer line, then explain why each distractor fails.

STUDY LINK

MCQ loop -> remedial loop -> register notes

HIGH

13. Workbook original solved Mains practice - 10 marks

GS-I / GS-II /
GS-III
Geography

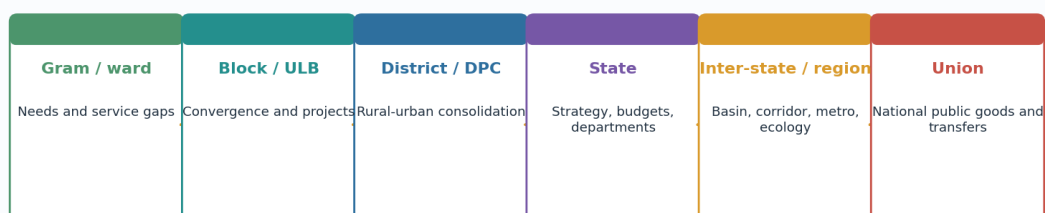
INTRO & ORIGIN

Solved UPSC Mains PYQ. The model answer follows claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification -> verdict.

CLAIM-EVIDENCE-ANALYSIS-QUALIFICATION-VERDICT ANSWER SPINE

Multi-level planning architecture

Upward consolidation should meet downward finance, standards, data and accountability.



Claim-evidence-analysis-qualification-verdict answer spine

Original deterministic study visual generated for this package; schematic, not a data source.

STATIC THEORY

- **Question (10 marks):** Explain why a planning region should not be equated with an administrative region. (150 words)
- **Directive and thesis:** A planning region is delimited for functional or ecological coherence, whereas an administrative region is delimited for legal authority and accountability; effective planning must bridge rather than erase the difference.
- **Claim 1:** Development problems cross boundaries. **Named evidence/example:** River basins, NCR's labour market and freight corridors extend across districts or states. **Analysis:** Functional processes require coordination beyond one administration.
- **Claim 2:** Administration supplies authority and finance. **Named evidence/example:** States, districts, DPCs and municipalities hold budgets, staff and democratic accountability. **Analysis:** A functional map without an implementing institution remains analytical.
- **Claim 3:** Hybrid design is therefore necessary. **Named evidence/example:** Basin boards, metropolitan committees, corridor authorities and inter-state agreements. **Analysis:** These overlay functional coordination on accountable governments.
- **Qualification:** Functional bodies can become technocratic and weakly accountable; administrative units cannot simply be bypassed.
- **Verdict:** The scoring distinction is functional fit versus accountable delivery, resolved through nested and negotiated multi-level planning.
- **Why this earns marks:** It answers every part of the directive, uses named evidence to prove each claim, explains the spatial mechanism, states a limitation and ends with a graded verdict.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Marks: 10.
2. Exact wording verified from a local official paper scan.
3. Every evidence unit is analytical, not decorative.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: A scheme list is an answer.

CORRECT: The answer must explain mechanism, evidence and limitation.

WRONG: A generic conclusion is enough.

CORRECT: The verdict must resolve the directive and scale.

MAINS ANGLE

Reproduce the structure under timed conditions and add a compact schematic.

STUDY LINK

Solved PYQ -> examiner-grade model -> revision

HIGH

14. Workbook original solved Mains practice - 15 marks

GS-I / GS-II /
GS-III
Geography

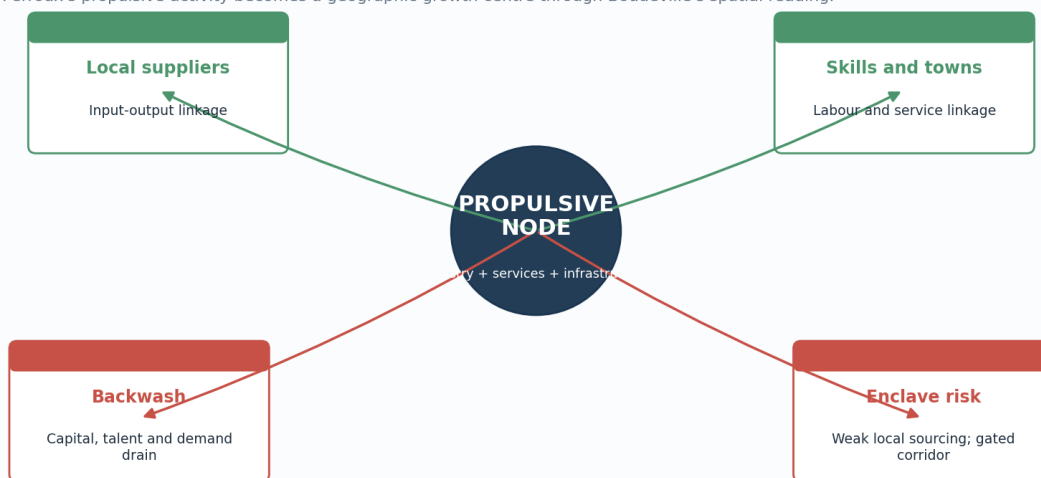
INTRO & ORIGIN

Solved UPSC Mains PYQ. The model answer follows claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification -> verdict.

CLAIM-EVIDENCE-ANALYSIS-QUALIFICATION-VERDICT ANSWER SPINE

Growth pole: spread is possible, not automatic

Perroux's propulsive activity becomes a geographic growth centre through Boudeville's spatial reading.



Claim-evidence-analysis-qualification-verdict answer spine

Original deterministic study visual generated for this package; schematic, not a data source.

STATIC THEORY

- **Question (15 marks):** Critically examine whether growth-pole and corridor strategies can reduce regional disparity in India. (250 words)
- **Directive and thesis:** Growth poles and corridors can lower coordination costs and create spread, but only when local linkages, intermediate towns and ecological safeguards prevent enclave and backwash effects.
- **Claim 1:** Concentration can achieve viable scale. **Named evidence/example:** Perroux/Boudeville growth-pole logic and industrial-corridor nodes. **Analysis:** Shared infrastructure, suppliers and labour markets can raise productivity.
- **Claim 2:** Spread requires deliberate transmission. **Named evidence/example:** Local procurement, MSME clusters, skills, regional transit and secondary towns. **Analysis:** These convert node growth into wider income and service multipliers.
- **Claim 3:** Backwash is a real counter-force. **Named evidence/example:** Myrdal's capital/talent drain and metropolitan concentration; mineral enclaves as an Indian caution. **Analysis:** Without bargaining power and local capability, the core can absorb resources while the periphery bears costs.
- **Claim 4:** Ecology changes the efficiency verdict. **Named evidence/example:** Water-stressed industrial nodes, land displacement and freight emissions. **Analysis:** Externalised costs can make apparent growth inefficient and inequitable.
- **Qualification:** Not every lagging place should host the same industry; people-based capabilities and mobility rights remain necessary.
- **Verdict:** Pole/corridor strategy is conditionally useful: judge it by local retention, job quality, network access, ecological cost and gap reduction, not investment announced.
- **Why this earns marks:** It answers every part of the directive, uses named evidence to prove each claim, explains the spatial mechanism, states a limitation and ends with a graded verdict.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Marks: 15.
2. Exact wording verified from a local official paper scan.
3. Every evidence unit is analytical, not decorative.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: A scheme list is an answer.

CORRECT: The answer must explain mechanism, evidence and limitation.

WRONG: A generic conclusion is enough.

CORRECT: The verdict must resolve the directive and scale.

MAINS ANGLE

Reproduce the structure under timed conditions and add a compact schematic.

STUDY LINK

Solved PYQ -> examiner-grade model -> revision

HIGH

15. Workbook original solved Mains practice - 20 marks

GS-I / GS-II /
GS-III
Geography

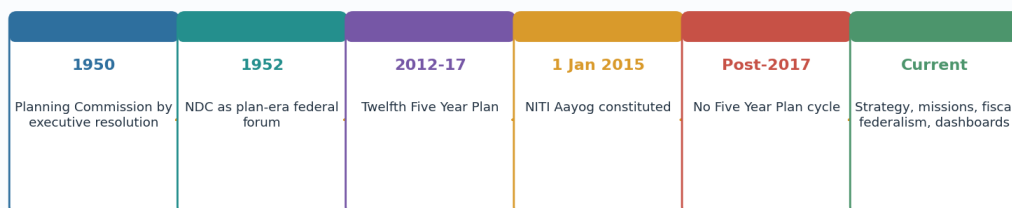
INTRO & ORIGIN

Solved UPSC Mains PYQ. The model answer follows claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification -> verdict.

CLAIM-EVIDENCE-ANALYSIS-QUALIFICATION-VERDICT ANSWER SPINE

Institutional transition: do not convert NITI into a Thirteenth Plan

The Planning Commission was replaced in 2015, but the Twelfth Plan ran to 2017. No new Five Year Plan followed.

*Claim-evidence-analysis-qualification-verdict answer spine*

Original deterministic study visual generated for this package; schematic, not a data source.

STATIC THEORY

- **Question (20 marks):** India has moved from Five Year Plans to a dispersed regional-development architecture. Analyse its strengths, gaps and reform priorities. (300 words)
- **Directive and thesis:** The post-Plan architecture is more federal, mission-based and data-rich, but fragmentation of finance, authority and local capacity can weaken long-horizon territorial strategy.
- **Claim 1:** The old architecture supplied a national medium-term frame. **Named evidence/example:** First to Twelfth Plan documents and Planning Commission/NDC processes. **Analysis:** It could coordinate public investment and articulate balanced-development goals.
- **Claim 2:** The current architecture is more plural and granular. **Named evidence/example:** Finance Commission transfers, NITI Governing Council, ADP/ABP, SDG indices, Gati-Shakti, DMF and sector missions. **Analysis:** It enables flexible federal participation and district/block targeting.
- **Claim 3:** Fiscal roles are clearer but dispersed. **Named evidence/example:** Article 280 devolution, Union Budget schemes and state/local finance. **Analysis:** Separation reduces opaque plan assistance but can fragment territorial prioritisation.
- **Claim 4:** Data improve attention but create metric risks. **Named evidence/example:** Delta rankings and OOMF output-outcome chains. **Analysis:** Comparability, gaming, within-region inequality and causality remain concerns.
- **Claim 5:** Reform needs a multi-level territorial compact. **Named evidence/example:** DPC/MPC strengthening, functional-region institutions, predictable local finance, capability funding and public evaluation. **Analysis:** This reconnects national public goods with local diagnosis and ecological limits.
- **Qualification:** The Planning Commission should not be romanticised: top-down allocation, weak local differentiation and incomplete balanced development were real limitations.
- **Verdict:** India does not need a mechanical return to Five Year Plans; it needs an accountable long-horizon regional strategy that integrates fiscal federalism, functional geography, local government, climate resilience and outcome evaluation.
- **Why this earns marks:** It answers every part of the directive, uses named evidence to prove each claim, explains the spatial mechanism, states a limitation and ends with a graded verdict.